

From capability to operating state.

A candidate thesis for turning enterprise AI deployments into adopted, measurable customer outcomes.

Go-live is a date. Value is an operating state. The deployment manager owns the phase change between them.

COMPANY MOMENT / DOCUMENTED PUBLIC SIGNALS

>\$100M ARR

Publicly reported in April 2026 as Cresta enters its next growth phase across the Fortune 500.

Growth and board announcement

2× faster build

Cresta says Conductor enables engineers to deploy production-grade AI agents twice as fast as before.

Conductor launch

One connected platform

Analyze, Automate, and Augment reinforce a continuous discovery-to-optimization customer loop.

TELUS Digital partnership

ACTUAL MANDATE

Nominal

Lead complex technical or AI-driven SaaS implementations end to end.

Actual

Convert product velocity into repeatable enterprise value by aligning technical readiness, operating change, frontline adoption, evidence, and ownership from discovery through post-launch optimization.

WHAT SUCCESS APPEARS TO REQUIRE

Customer outcome

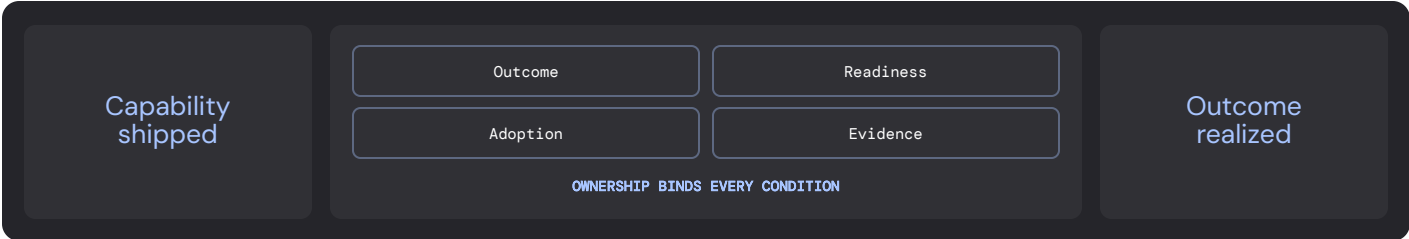
- Solutions launch and are used.
- Success metrics are defined before go-live.
- Customers finish deployment confident and ready to scale.

Internal operating value

- Complex initiatives gain clarity and momentum.
- Product, Engineering, Customer Success, and GTM receive useful signal.
- Delivery learning becomes more reusable without erasing customer context.

The work at
the boundary.

A role-derived model—not a claim about Cresta's proprietary implementation process.



FOUR ACTIVATION CONDITIONS

01 / Outcome
Baseline, business metric, target, decision owner, and the operational meaning of “better.”
Failure: activity without business movement

02 / Readiness
Data, integration, policy, security, dependency, exception, and delivery conditions.
Failure: a green plan with red prerequisites

03 / Adoption
Frontline behavior, supervisor reinforcement, enablement, trust, feedback, and change burden.
Failure: availability mistaken for use

04 / Evidence
Evaluation, telemetry, quality threshold, business delta, intervention, and optimization signal.
Failure: go-live becomes the last measured event

STAKEHOLDER TOPOLOGY

Customer side
Executive sponsor · contact-center operations · IT/security · frontline leaders · agents · analytics · change owners

Cresta side
Deployment · Forward-Deployed Engineering · Product · Engineering · Customer Success · Value/Analytics · GTM

Boundary risk
Different definitions of ready, valuable, adopted, safe, and done create decision delay.

DECISION RIGHTS / HYPOTHESIS FOR DISCOVERY

DECISION	CUSTOMER OWNER	DEPLOYMENT LEAD	TECHNICAL OWNER	SUCCESS / VALUE
Outcome & baseline	Approves business meaning	Clarifies and records	Tests measurability	Validates value logic
Release / hold	Accepts operating risk	Facilitates decision	Owns technical evidence	Confirms success criteria
Adoption action	Owns behavior change	Surfaces burden and plan	Supports workflow	Tracks usage quality
Expand / optimize	Funds and prioritizes	Connects learning	Sizes technical work	Tests incremental value

Measure the state, not the ceremony.

A balanced view of delivery health, customer behavior, and business impact.

SUCCESS-MEASURE FRAMEWORK / HYPOTHESIS FOR DISCOVERY

Delivery health	Decision latency · dependency aging · scope confidence · milestone reliability	Question: are we moving for the right reason?
Adoption health	Usage quality · behavior adherence · supervisor reinforcement · feedback participation	Question: did the work actually change?
Model / solution health	Evaluation threshold · exception rate · quality · intervention signal · release stability	Question: is performance safe and explainable?
Business health	AHT · ACW · FCR · containment · CSAT/NPS · revenue · quality—as appropriate	Question: did the intended metric move?
Scale readiness	Customer confidence · ownership · optimization backlog · next-use-case economics	Question: did deployment create the right to expand?

VERIFIED EVIDENCE MAP

Vape-Jet

AI-first operating transformation across customer, factory, support, engineering, ERP, CRM, telemetry, training, and accountability.
Adoption · signals · cross-functional work

Amazon

24/7 customer-backward launch and execution; operating mechanisms, visibility, escalation, and standard work.
Launch · cadence · customer promise

Compunetics

Engineering, manufacturing, quality, customer delivery, and complex technical programs in high-reliability environments.
Translation · rigor · consequential delivery

DudeWorth

AI readiness, feasibility, governance, adoption burden, human authority, evaluation, reuse, and time-to-value frameworks.
Framing · readiness · AI workflow design

HARD OBJECTION

“Russell's strongest evidence is deployment-shaped operating leadership—not a decade of contact-center SaaS implementation.”
That gap should be examined, not hidden. The adjacent evidence is technical-customer programs, operating launches, AI-enabled workflow transformation, telemetry, training, standard work, and governance. The value proposition is the ability to learn Cresta's product and delivery system quickly while bringing mature operating mechanics to the customer boundary.
No production CCaaS ownership is claimed.

WHAT THIS CANDIDATE WOULD NOT DO

Prescribe early

Observe the existing system before redesigning it.

Confuse activity with impact

Connect milestones to adoption and customer metrics.

Hide the gap

Use evidence and learning posture instead of inflated claims.

Questions worth bringing into the room.

Designed to reveal the operating system behind the job description.

EXECUTIVE INTERVIEW QUESTIONS

- 01 When Colin and the team call a deployment healthy, which signals matter before go-live—and which matter thirty days after it?
- 02 Where do otherwise strong Cresta deployments most often lose momentum: customer decisions, data and integration readiness, frontline adoption, or post-launch ownership?
- 03 How are responsibilities divided among AI Deployment, Forward-Deployed Engineering, Customer Success, Product, and the customer's operating team?
- 04 As Conductor compresses build time, what new pressure does that create for customer discovery, decision-making, change management, or measurement?
- 05 What does an excellent Deployment Manager make easier for the customer that the product cannot solve on its own?
- 06 How does deployment learning currently travel back into product priorities, reusable playbooks, and commercial scoping?
- 07 What is the hardest plausible concern about my background for this role, and what evidence would help you resolve it?
- 08 Twelve months from now, what would make you say this hire materially improved how Cresta turns launches into scalable customer value?

PUBLIC SOURCE NOTES

[AI Deployment Manager job posting](#)
[Cresta growth and board announcement · April 30, 2026](#)
[Cresta Conductor launch · June 11, 2026](#)
[TELUS Digital implementation partnership · June 15, 2026](#)
[Automation Discovery · December 2, 2025](#)
[Cresta AI-agent testing and deployment](#)
[United Airlines implementation story · July 11, 2024](#)

USE IN THE INTERVIEW

The brief is a conversation instrument—not a claim of inside knowledge.

Public facts are sourced. Career facts are verified. Proposed measures, decision rights, and the Activation Boundary are hypotheses meant to sharpen discovery with the people who actually run Cresta's deployment system.